Suraj Nayak

Principal Engineer – Site Reliability Engineering

AWS SA Pro · GCP DevOps Pro · Azure SA Expert · CKA

Cloud | Kubernetes | CI/CD | GitOps | SRE | Platform Engineering

PROFILE

Principal SRE & Platform Engineer with **10+ years** across high-growth startups and enterprise organizations, architecting high-velocity software delivery platforms on AWS, GCP, and hybrid environments. Expert in CI/CD, GitOps, service mesh, IaC, and FinOps — platforms serving 150+ engineers and 500K+ daily transactions, cutting deployment lead time by **40%**, and eliminating 20–30% of cloud spend. Consistent track record of turning platform investment into measurable, organization-wide engineering efficiency gains.

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer – Site Reliability Engineering — DataBahn

05/2026 – Present • Data Pipeline • Owning platform for 150+ engineers across 8 squads

- **Platform V2:** Designed and led next-gen platform with event-driven architecture on **Apache Pulsar**; decoupled 5 core services, reducing cascading failures by **35%** and improving system resilience.
- **Architecture Leadership:** Drove technical decisions for API management (APISIX), workflow orchestration (Camunda), and IaC (Pulumi, Terraform) across 8 squads; cut environment provisioning from hours to **under 15 min**.
- **DORA Metrics:** Introduced deployment frequency, lead time, and MTTR tracking across 8 squads — cut mean deployment lead time by **40%** and surfaced bottlenecks within 30 days.
- **GitOps & Decomposition:** Standardized GitOps-based release workflows and drove service decomposition for 5 core services, cutting cross-team coordination overhead by **50%**.

Sr. Software Engineer – Platform & Infrastructure — Roku

02/2024 – 05/2026 • Streaming Platform, ~$4B revenue • Platform IC, 12 teams, ~800-person eng org

- **Workload Identity Federation:** Designed and implemented WIF across AWS EKS and GCP GKE for seamless multi-cloud workload authentication; eliminated all long-lived service account keys, reducing credential exposure surface by **80%**.
- **Cross-AZ Traffic Optimization:** Configured Istio locality load balancing and topology-aware routing to restrict unnecessary cross-AZ traffic; reduced inter-zone data transfer costs by **~35%** while maintaining sub-5ms P99 latency within each zone.
- **Istio Mesh Migration from Nginx:** Led org-wide migration of 50+ services from Nginx Ingress to Istio service mesh; introduced mTLS, circuit breakers, and retries — eliminated 3 classes of network-level incidents and reduced mesh-related error rate by **72%**.
- **Service Onboarding Automation:** Built standardized onboarding pipeline (Helm templates, sidecar injection, auto-instrumentation); reduced new service mesh onboarding from **2 weeks to 1 day** across 12 teams.
- **Progressive Delivery & Compliance:** GitOps-driven canary/blue-green pipelines cut lead time by **40%**, rollback from 25 min to **3 min**; OPA/Gatekeeper policies achieved **zero violations** across a 6-month audit; OpenTelemetry tracing reduced MTTR by **60%**.

Staff Engineer – Cloud Platform — AiDash Pvt. Ltd.

02/2022 – 02/2024 • Climate-Tech SaaS • Led team of 6 platform engineers

- Led full data center exit to AWS (EKS) and Azure (AKS) per Well-Architected Framework; **zero SLA breach** across 12 months of migration.
- Decomposed 3 monolithic apps into **20+ containerized microservices**; improved deploy cadence from bi-weekly to daily with zero-downtime releases.
- Designed FinOps controls — HPA/KEDA autoscaling, spot strategies, utilization dashboards — cutting cloud spend by **30% (~$120K/year)**.
- Built reusable Terraform module library; standardized CI/CD pipelines across 6 teams, cutting service onboarding from **3 weeks to 2 days**.

Cloud Engineer – Platform & IDP — Cargill Pvt. Ltd.

11/2019 – 02/2022 • Fortune 500, Agri-Enterprise

- Contributed to "Captain" — self-service deployment portal enabling dev→production without SRE intervention; eliminated **80% of manual tickets**, reduced time-to-deploy by **65%** across 15 teams.
- Architected solutions meeting **99.99% (4-nines) SLA** via automated failover, DR runbooks, and chaos exercises; zero outage breaches in 18 months.
- Implemented autoscaling and rate-limiting cutting monthly AWS spend by **20% (~$80K/year)**; eliminated 90% of daily toil via Python/Bash automation.

Cloud Solution Architect — Microland Pvt. Ltd.

07/2016 – 11/2019

- Managed Kubernetes migration and lifecycle for **10+ enterprise clients** on AWS EKS; delivered IaC-first infrastructure standards adopted practice-wide.
- Built centralized observability stack (CloudWatch, Thanos, Grafana, EFK); reduced alert noise by **40%** and won **3 strategic accounts** through PoC delivery.

SKILLS & COMPETENCES

CI/CD & GitOps | Kubernetes | AWS | GCP | Azure | Terraform | Helm / Kustomize | Istio / Envoy | Workload Identity | ArgoCD | Argo Rollouts | Karpenter | Backstage | Observability | DORA Metrics | FinOps | DevSecOps | SRE | Chaos Engineering | OPA / Gatekeeper | Prometheus | Grafana | OpenTelemetry | KEDA | Thanos | SOPS / Vault | Python | Go | Docker

SELECTED INITIATIVES

Multi-Cluster GitOps Platform — at Roku

ArgoCD • Terraform • EKS/GKE • OPA/Gatekeeper

- GitOps control plane managing **12 K8s clusters** across 3 AWS regions + GCP; automated drift detection and self-healing reconciliation loops.
- Progressive promotion (dev→staging→prod) via ApplicationSets; failure rate **<0.5%** with full SOC2 audit trail.

Internal Developer Portal — "LaunchPad" — at Cargill

Backstage • GitHub Actions • Terraform • Python

- Self-service IDP with 8 golden path templates; cut new service time-to-production from **3 weeks to 4 hours**.
- Live K8s health, cost attribution, and DORA metrics in a single catalog; **90% reduction** in manual platform requests.

FinOps Automation Engine — at AiDash

Python • AWS Cost Explorer • CAST.AI • Grafana

- Event-driven cost governance with anomaly detection and OPA budget guardrails; **$200K+/year savings** across 3 organizations.
- Per-team dashboards drove **35% reduction** in idle resource spend within 60 days of rollout.

AI-Assisted Incident Response — at DataBahn

Python • LLM APIs • PagerDuty • Prometheus • Jira

- AI SRE agent correlating alerts with runbooks; reduced mean time to triage by **55%** and on-call fatigue by **40%**.
- Automated Jira incident creation with root-cause hypotheses; adopted by 3 platform teams as primary on-call tool.

EDUCATION

B.Tech — Computer Science Engineering

NIT Trichy (National Institute of Technology) • First Class • 2012–2016

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)
- Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS)
- AWS Certified DevOps Engineer – Professional
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional
- GCP Professional Cloud DevOps Engineer
- Istio Certified Associate (ICA)
- Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305)